BEST FOOT FORWARD

In December 2021, the Brihanmumbai Electricity Supply and Transport (BEST) Undertaking became the first bus service provider in the country to introduce smart cards and a mobile app, both named 'Chalo'. The app is used for booking tickets and live tracking of bus movements. Two years ago, BEST had brought in electric buses. These initiatives have helped reduce losses, waiting time and use of fuel. Here are some facts and figures about BEST's fleet of buses and the ongoing overhaul.

By KIRAN D. TARE

3,600
Total buses

386
Electric buses

3,000
Electric buses to run by end of 2023

27
Bus depots

4
Depots with charging facility for electric buses

6,000
MILLION LITRES
Fuel expected to be saved by 2032





50%
Passengers with smart cards

₹6.5 CRORE
Annual savings on coin-handling charges paid to banks

₹3 CRORE
Savings on printing tickets





GETTY IMAGES

20
MINUTES
Maximum waiting time in January 2022

15
MINUTES
Maximum waiting time in June 2022

136
Dedicated buses for women passengers



60
Buses required per one lakh people

20
Buses BEST has per one lakh people

₹2,100
CRORE
Revenue loss per year

2026
The year when BEST is expected to break even in terms of revenue after the overhaul

Source: The BEST Undertaking

"We have focused on reducing our operational cost and the effects are visible. In three years, our losses will come down to almost zero. At the same time, our priority is to increase reliability and availability of BEST buses"

–LOKESH CHANDRA
General Manager, BEST

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